

PCS / VA Home Buyer Guide

Maximize Your Earned VA Home Loan Benefit With Confidence



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REALTORS® • YOUR LOCAL MILITARY COMMUNITY EXPERTS**S2 Home Partners • Momentum Realty****Sarah Fuller:** (434) 713-1221 | **Sarah Luther:** (850) 328-9800**Email:** S2HomePartners@gmail.com

SECTION 01 | Welcome & About Your Professional

"Taking the step to buy a home is a massive milestone. As someone who has served or is currently supporting our military community, you've earned an incredible benefit: the VA home loan. This guide is designed to cut through the noise, debunk common myths, and outline exactly what to expect from start to finish. We are committed to ensuring your transaction is completely seamless, beautifully structured, and highly successful."

MEET YOUR PROFESSIONAL: As a proud Active-Duty Military Spouse and certified Military Relocation Professional (MRP), I don't just understand the logistics of a military move—I live them. I know firsthand the unique timelines, PCS stresses, and housing transitions that military families navigate, because my own family handles them right alongside you.

With deep expertise in real estate operations, property management, and comprehensive transaction coordination, my mission is to ensure your home-buying journey is flawless from contract to close. Having successfully overseen millions of dollars in real estate sales and managed hundreds of intricate accounts, I specialize in streamlining the complex paperwork and operational details so you can focus on your family's next chapter.

You have earned an incredible benefit in the VA Home Loan. I am honored to combine my professional transaction expertise with my personal military background to help you maximize that benefit, build long-term wealth, and find the perfect place to call home.

SECTION 02 | Core Requirements & Eligibility

The VA loan program is an unparalleled benefit. You do not have to be in active combat, deployed, or retired to qualify. Primary eligible service categories include:

ACTIVE-DUTY SERVICE MEMBERS

Qualify after **90 continuous days** of active duty. You can leverage this benefit fully before separate orders or military transition.

VETERANS

Wartime: **90 days** active duty. Peacetime: **181 continuous days**. Service spanning Sept 1980 – Aug 1990 typically requires 24 months.

NATIONAL GUARD & RESERVE

Qualify if activated under federal orders for **90 days**, or completed **6 years** of credentialed service with an honorable discharge.

SURVIVING SPOUSES

Eligible if spouse passed away in service or from service-connected disability (unremarried prior to 57). DIC recipients skip the funding fee.



SECTION 03 | Loan Side-by-Side Comparison

Feature	VA Loan (Your Benefit)	Conventional Loan	FHA Loan
Down Payment	0%	3% to 20%	3.5%
Mortgage Insurance	None (\$0 / mo)	PMI (Until 20% equity)	MIP (Life of loan)
Interest Rate	Typically lower than market	Baseline market rate	Similar to Conventional
Credit Score	No VA minimum (Lender flex)	620+	580+
Loan Limit	No limit (Full entitlement)	County caps apply	County caps apply
Assumable?	Yes	No	Yes

REAL DOLLAR METRICS (\$300,000 PURCHASE EXAMPLE)

Metric	VA Loan	Conventional Loan	FHA Loan
Down Payment Out-of-Pocket	\$0	\$15,000 (5%)	\$10,500 (3.5%)
Monthly Mortgage Insurance	\$0 / month	~\$100 – \$200 / mo	~\$140 / mo
Upfront Program Fee	Financed Funding Fee	None	1.75% MIP (\$5,250)

SECTION 04 | The Step-by-Step Buying Roadmap

- 01

Certificate of Eligibility (COE)

Proves to mortgage lenders that you meet the necessary service timeline requirements to access the VA loan benefit program. It can be pulled directly via the eBenefits portal or by your lender.
- 02

Strategic Pre-Approval

Locks down your precise purchasing numbers, defines monthly dynamics, and shows sellers you are ready. VA interest rates regularly run under standard market averages.
- 03

Select & Partner with a Military Specialist

Guidance on Minimum Property Requirements (MPRs), real estate coordination timelines, and writing hyper-competitive offers that safeguard your earnest cash reserves.
- 04

Property Search & Targeted House Hunting

Tour homes actively observing structural factors. Your agent will help identify any visible elements that might conflict with the VA's foundational safety and operational guidelines.
- 05

Submitting an Offer

VA ESCAPE CLAUSE

Every single offer includes the critical VA Escape Clause. This legal mechanism completely protects your earnest money deposit if the professional appraisal values drop below the agreed contract price.
- 06

Application & Loan Processing

Once your contract is locked in, formal processing initiates. Your lending professional will issue a clear Loan Estimate detailing numbers inside 3 structural business days.
- 07

Professional Appraisal & Safety Check

An independent certified professional appraiser assesses the property value and validates compliance with Minimum Property Requirements (MPRs) for baseline home safety and structural preservation.
- 08

Rigorous Underwriting

The lending team meticulously cross-references your absolute asset histories, verification paystubs, tax docs, and appraisal files to clear the transaction for final settlement processing.
- 09

The Official Closing Day

Execute your final paperwork at the closing title office. Remember your official government photo ID and a cashier's check or wire for any relevant settlement out-of-pockets. The keys are officially yours!

SECTION 05 | Closing Costs & Financial Realities

While a VA loan features 0% down payment requirements, transaction processing settlement costs remain a factor. Understanding permissible and non-permissible charges gives you full financial clarity.

PERMISSIBLE CHARGES (BUYER PAYS)

- Appraisal & credit check processing
- Local title insurance policies
- Lender origination (capped tightly at 1%)
- Escrow prepaids (taxes, home insurance)

VA-EXEMPTED (BUYER CANNOT PAY)

- Lending company attorney review costs
- Processing / administrative fees
- Brokerage transaction fees
- Document preparation charges

THE 4% SELLER CONCESSION CAPITAL

We can systematically write terms asking the seller to subsidize up to **4% of the complete deal value** toward your total transaction fees, paying down debts, or clearing settlement balances entirely.

THE FUNDING FEE & DISABILITY EXEMPTIONS

A structural fee built directly into the total loan base to support the program. **Important Exemption:** If you are receiving monthly VA disability compensation or are an eligible surviving spouse, this structural fee is **entirely waived**.

SECTION 06 | Strategic Asset Gathering & Checklist

REQUIRED VERIFICATION PAPERWORK

Gather these documents early to accelerate your file submission processing drastically:

- ☐ **Statement of Service:** Active Duty — Signed by Command
- ☐ **Current Military LES:** Leave & Earnings Statement (Latest 2 months)
- ☐ **W-2 Documents & Tax Returns:** Past 2 fiscal years
- ☐ **Pay Verification Stubs:** Past 30 days of continuous pay stubs
- ☐ **Asset Bank Statements:** Past 60 days of full statements (all pages)

CORE QUESTIONS FOR YOUR VA LENDER

- What is my exact structural base entitlement funding amount?
- Are there localized or internal lender overlays that modify credit rules?
- How will my disability status actively eliminate standard funding fees?

YOU EARNED THIS. LET'S USE IT.

Thank you for reviewing this guide, and most importantly, thank you for your dedicated service. Navigating structural real estate logistics is our absolute signature expertise.

HONORED TO GUIDE YOU HOME.

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